

B1 Personal Progression

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Personal Progression

You should explore a range of career opportunities, produce valuable materials and demonstrate specialist skills relating to your goals for personal progression.

B1.1 Inform ideas for progression into a creative career

The Industry

I would like to work within the creative technology and interactive media industry, particularly in a role where creative design and programming are combined. I am interested in developing digital products and experiences where both the visual design and technical development contribute to the finished project. This could include roles such as a web developer, front-end developer, creative developer, interactive media developer or, potentially, a game developer.

I am interested in this industry because I enjoy the process of taking an idea and turning it into something that can actually be used or experienced. I particularly like projects where I can make creative decisions while also solving technical problems. This is one of the reasons I have enjoyed studying Creative iMedia and learning programming alongside it. My current skills include using Visual Studio Code, HTML, CSS and JavaScript, as well as creative software such as Adobe Photoshop and Illustrator. I am also interested in expanding my knowledge of other software and programming languages as my career develops.

- Another reason I am interested in this industry is the variety of work available. Rather than completing exactly the same task every day, creative technology projects can involve designing, programming, testing, communicating with clients and solving problems. I would particularly like a role where I can work as part of a team while also having opportunities to communicate with clients and understand their requirements.

Jobs and Roles

There are several careers that could suit my interests. A front-end developer would focus on creating the visual and interactive parts of websites and applications using technologies such as HTML, CSS and JavaScript. A creative developer combines programming with creative design to produce interactive digital experiences. An interactive media developer can work on websites, applications, games and other digital experiences. A game developer would use programming and creative skills to develop games and interactive environments.

- At this stage, I do not want to restrict myself to one specific job title. Instead, I want to develop a combination of creative and technical skills so that I can decide which area suits me best after gaining more experience.

Employment Opportunities

There are several ways of working within this industry. A person can work as a permanent employee for a creative agency, technology company, game studio or other organisation. This would provide the opportunity to work as part of a team on larger projects.

Freelance work is another option. A freelancer can work directly with clients and be paid for individual projects rather than being permanently employed by one company. This provides greater independence but also requires the freelancer to find clients, manage deadlines, communicate professionally and manage their own finances.

Self-employment could also allow me to establish my own creative business in the future.

However, I would first want to gain experience working for an organisation or completing smaller freelance projects before considering this as my main source of income.

My Progression Aims

My short-term goal is to successfully complete Year 13 and achieve or exceed my predicted grades, including my target of D*D*D in Creative iMedia. I also want to continue developing my HTML, CSS and JavaScript skills through my coursework and personal projects.

- My medium-term goal is to progress into higher education or an apprenticeship related to computing, web development, interactive media or another course that combines technical and creative skills. During this stage, I want to build a portfolio containing several different projects that demonstrate both my creative and technical abilities.
- My long-term goal is to gain employment in a creative technology or interactive development role. I would like to progress from an entry-level position into a more experienced role where I can take greater responsibility for projects, communicate with clients and potentially lead parts of the creative or technical development process.

Industry Demand

The creative technology industry continues to develop as organisations increasingly depend on websites, applications, digital content and interactive experiences. However, competition for entry-level positions can be high, particularly because employers can expect junior applicants to have relevant qualifications, technical skills, portfolios and practical experience.

- Artificial intelligence is also changing the industry, since AI tools can automate or assist with some entry-level tasks, meaning that simply knowing how to produce basic code or designs may become less valuable. However, this also increases the importance of skills such as problem solving, creativity, communication, critical thinking and the ability to understand a client's requirements. I therefore believe that developing a combination of technical and creative skills will make me more adaptable as the industry changes.

I will need to continue learning throughout my career because software, programming languages and industry practices are constantly developing.

B1.2 Apply problem solving practice to develop a strategy for career progression

Progressions aims

- Alongside my education, I want to improve my technical skills, particularly HTML, CSS and JavaScript. I also want to continue developing my knowledge of Adobe Photoshop and Illustrator and learn additional software where it would benefit my future career.
Another important short-term goal is to develop a professional portfolio. I will use my Creative iMedia coursework and personal projects to demonstrate my ability to combine creative design with technical development. One of my main projects is my interactive game, which will allow me to demonstrate programming, interface design, problem solving, planning and creative development.
- My medium-term goal is to enter higher education or an apprenticeship after completing sixth form. I am currently considering both routes because they provide different advantages.
A university course would allow me to develop my technical and creative knowledge in greater depth while giving me opportunities to work on larger projects and build my portfolio. An apprenticeship would allow me to gain qualifications while also gaining practical experience within an organisation.

- My long-term goal is to establish a career in a role where I can combine creative and technical skills. Depending on how my interests develop, this could be as a creative developer, front-end developer, interactive media developer, web developer or potentially a game developer.
- There are several areas that I need to improve to achieve my career aims. My main technical development area is programming. I currently have experience with HTML, CSS and JavaScript, but I need to become more confident with these languages and develop my ability to create larger and more complex projects.
I also need to continue improving my creative software skills. Photoshop and Illustrator are useful for creating and preparing digital assets, branding and interface designs. I will use online tutorials and practical projects to improve these skills.

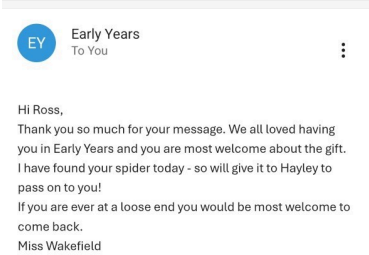
• **Work Experience**



Miss Wakefield, Mrs O'Connor, Miss Langley,

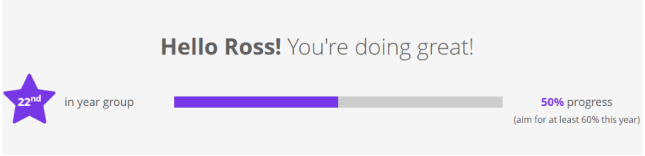
Thank you so much for letting me work with you for these last two weeks. I'll definitely remember this, as I had a great time with you and the students, and I'm glad I could be of help.
You didn't have to give such a gift to me, but I'll gratefully accept it.
If you ever need me for something, you can always contact me.
I hope you have a great long-weekend, and once again, thank you for having me.

Ross



Applying for university courses or apprenticeships

- Demonstratré applying for university courses



- Show how you have used government sites to help find suitable apprenticeships.

Creating a personal statement

Personal statement
by Ross Thurgood

UK universities will see the statement broken up into 3 sections. However to see how the whole thing reads together, here it is as one block of text.

I want to study a creative engineering course to further my understanding of physical and digital skills, so that I can apply them in real world scenarios and learn more about them. It would greatly help any skill for a job and I could easily transfer my learnt skills to other topics. By doing this, my understanding of creative design will increase and I could be able to help others as according to the knowledge I would know.

My qualifications and education has provided and improved my combination of problem solving and creative skills. I have developed my capabilities to be able to plan out my outcome and work with or without planned steps and carrying out constant research to change and adapt to improve or counter any issue I come across, learning so that it can be avoided in future experiences. Using these skills I have been able to create and update an online portfolio available to be viewed publicly by any employer or admissions team. This also allowed me to learn how to code, giving me the ability to write in different languages to help improve the design of my site to make it unique and memorable compared to the millions of others online. I have developed the skill to process and visualise problems and solutions to help me understand and enhance my work to my best capability.

- Document advice/feedback you have been given to help improve your personal statement

Creating my professional CV

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PROFILE

A motivated sixth-form student at Swayne Park School with a strong track record of leadership, creativity, and community engagement. Alongside A-levels in Mathematics and Physics and a BTEC in Creative Media, I have served as a school prefect, technical director of multiple school musical productions, and a Scout leader-in-training. I am experienced in graphic design and web development, and I bring a disciplined, team-oriented approach to everything I take on.

EDUCATION

A-Levels & BTEC | Swayne Park School Sixth Form, Rayleigh Sept 2024 – Present

- A-Level Mathematics (predicted: C)
- A-Level Physics (predicted: D)
- BTEC Level 3 Creative Media Practice (predicted: Triple Distinction)
- Extended Project Qualification (EPQ) – Chemical Science (in progress)
- Note: A-Level predictions are early-year estimates and expected to improve.

GCSEs – 8 subjects | Swayne Park School, Rayleigh June 2025

- Mathematics – 8 | Combined Science (Triple) – 7-7 | French – 6 | English Language – 6 (Spoken Language: Merit)
- English Literature – 5 | Drama – 5 | Geography – 4
- Cambridge National Creative Media – Merit at Level 2

SKILLS

Design & Digital Media Adobe Photoshop (CS6), Dreamweaver, Flash, vector illustration, logo design, poster design, photo manipulation

Web Development HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript — built and maintain personal portfolio site (rossthurgood.co.uk)

Core Competencies Leadership, teamwork, public speaking, problem solving, planning, adaptability

Other Piano (3 years formal lessons), basic first aid, campcraft & navigation (DofE expeditions)

WORK EXPERIENCE & VOLUNTEERING

Physics Subject Ambassador | Swayne Park School Sept 2025 – Present

- Represent the Physics department at internal and primary school outreach events.
- Assist younger year groups and primary pupils with science activities and demonstrations.

Young Leader in Scouting | 6th Rayleigh Cub Scouts Oct 2025 – Present

- Attend weekly Cub Scout meetings to plan and run activities for children aged 8-10.
- Support adult leaders and act as a positive role model for younger members.

Science Week Volunteer | Downhall Primary School, Rayleigh March 2026

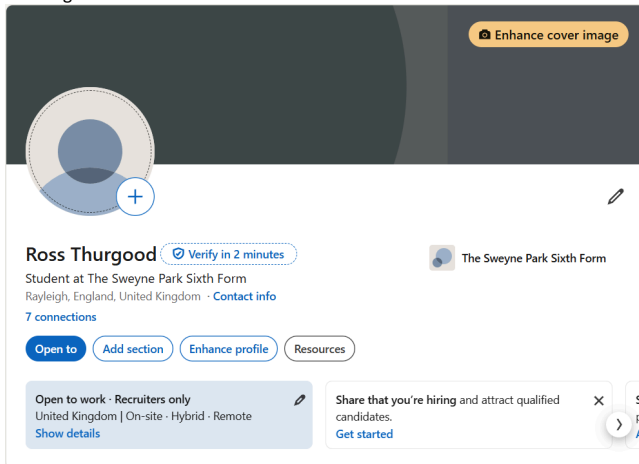
- Delivered hands-on science experiments to over 50 children across a full school day.
- Explained scientific concepts in an engaging and age-appropriate way.

Work Experience – Reception Class Teaching Assistant | Downhall Primary School, Rayleigh Apr – May 2024

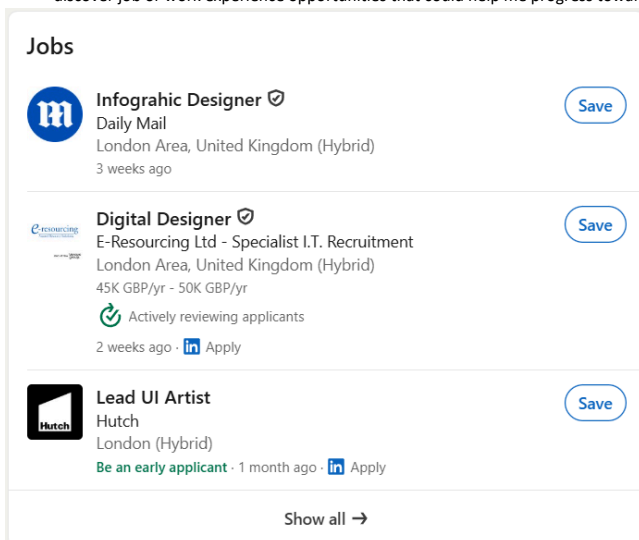
- Two-week full-time placement (09:00-16:00) supporting a class of 4-6 year olds.
- Led play-based learning activities, assisted reading sessions and outdoor play, and managed daily classroom routines alongside the class teacher.

- When creating my CV, I looked at examples and guidance on what makes a CV clear, professional and suitable for employers. I considered the importance of including relevant information such as my education, skills, work experience and achievements, while keeping the layout organised and easy to read. I also used feedback and advice I had previously received when creating CVs to improve the structure and presentation. I understand that a CV should be tailored to the specific job I am applying for, so I can highlight the skills and experience that are most relevant to each employer.

Creating a linked-in account



- I created a LinkedIn profile to help me build an online professional presence and explore potential career opportunities. When setting up my profile, I included information about my education, skills, work experience and interests so that employers can get an overview of my background. I also looked at other LinkedIn profiles and considered what information would be useful to include on my own profile. I have identified creative careers that interest me, particularly roles involving coding and graphics design. Having a LinkedIn profile will allow me to keep track of my experience and achievements, follow companies and discover job or work experience opportunities that could help me progress towards a creative career.

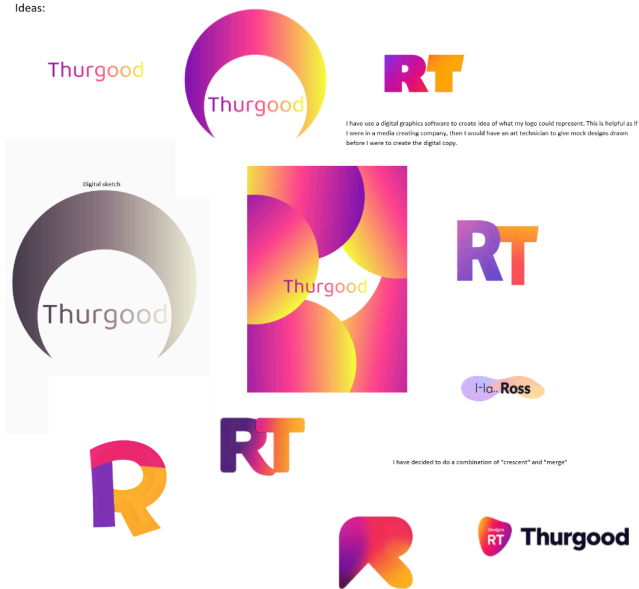


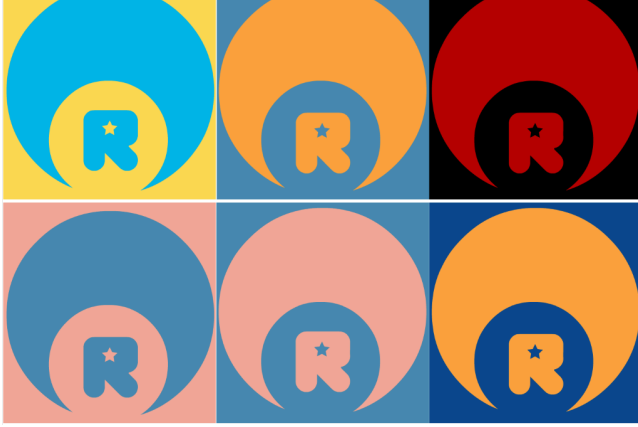
B1.3 Create materials for career progression using technical practice

You now need to create a brand identity for yourself. Your logo and branding will be used to personalise your own digital portfolio, where you will showcase your work ready for interviews.

Creating my brand

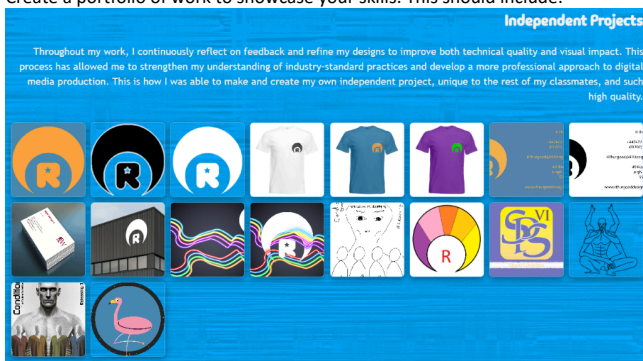
Ideas:





Creating my interview Portfolio

Create a portfolio of work to showcase your skills. This should include:



Creating contact/business cards



B1.4 Demonstrate professional practice & behaviours in relation to career aspirations

B1.5 Apply communication skills to support progression into a creative career

- Present your portfolio in a mock interview to prepare yourself for university and apprenticeship interviews.
- Review your interview technique and evaluate your performance